The Italian and Mediterranean Colloquium
presents

Borders in the Ocean: Identity and Otherness in the Italian Navy Ocean Diaries

Thursday, December 6, 2018
6:00pm, Room 501 Hamilton Hall

Emilio Cocco
Università degli studi di Teramo, Italy-American University of Rome
Presenter

Naor Ben-Yehoyada
Columbia University
Respondent

Konstantina Zanou
Columbia University
Moderator

In this talk, Cocco will discuss the national self-representations and the description of otherness as they appear in the logbooks and diaries written by Italian Navy officers on duty in ocean travels in the second part of the 19th century. The aim is to understand how the relation with otherness, mediated by the liminal space of the ocean, contributed to ongoing definitions of national identity. Cocco sheds light on the role played by the Italian Navy in the nation-building process and assess the latter's importance in affecting the relation between modern Italian society and the sea. The hope is to provide an original seaborne reading of the "making of Italy", which will challenge conventional representations of the country that see it as a naturally peninsular phenomenon and only accidentally as a global one.

Sponsored by **The Department of Italian**, **The European Institute**, **The Institute for Social and Economic Research and Policy**, and **The Department of Anthropology**

To RSVP please email kz2269@columbia.edu and pmt2114@columbia.edu
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